

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

12th December, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

50th WEEK



ELECTIONS IN NEPAL

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... INDIA AND ITS NEIGHBORHOOD-RELATIONS



Learning Space

LIVE



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

12th DECEMBER, 2017

1

A massive victory

Nepal's Left Alliance has the strength to deliver on governance

Given Nepal's chaotic history post the post system and proportional representation, the final picture of the Left Alliance may take some time to be clear. But it is already evident that the Left Alliance is en route to win more than 20% of the 275 parliamentary seats being decided by the FPTP system. For the 100 seats allocated based on proportional representation, the Communist Party of Nepal (Unified Marxist-Leninist) is leading, with its ally, the Communist Party of Nepal (Maoist Central), not far behind. This is a decisive victory for the Left Alliance, the first such win for the leftists since Nepal turned democratic in 1990. The CPN had also emerged as the single largest party in the local elections held earlier this year, with the Maoists joining them in the run-up to the parliamentary polls, the resulting alliance has proved to be ideologically coherent. The UML expanded its support base beyond the hill towns and the Terai into the far west and the upper hills, while the Maoists, who had flourished in elections since the formation of the Constituent Assembly in 2008, got second place and started off decline. For the Nepal Congress, the third place finish is a severe blow, limiting it to its weaker parliamentary presence. Others in the "democratic alliance" led by the NC, the pluri-banar Madhesi parties and the former royalist parties that cited using the Hindu card, have also received a setback.

It is quite clear that the Left Alliance's win flows from a yearning for a stable and lasting government after years of political instability. This is reflected in the fact that 13 leaders have held the post of Prime Minister since 1990. The Left Alliance has been successful and coming together of like-minded forces which had not given up on reflection and were willing to work within the parliamentary system. With such a big mandate, it is not an overstatement to say it is finally forming a government. Such a situation is a milestone for a state in the past too – during the initial sitting of the Constituent Assembly almost a decade ago when nearly the entire polity voted for Nepal to become a republic, or when the peace process between the Nepali state and the Maoists was completed, or after the earthquake in 2015 when political parties decided to quickly narrow down their differences on the Constitution in order to work together. But they all lapsed into more political wrangling. The Left Alliance now has both the opportunity and the strength to deliver on governance and development. As for the NC, the grand old party of Nepal has much to intercept on. It was blindsided by the formation of the Left Alliance and its own rightist alliance was found to be wanting. It will now have to step up to play its role in opposition.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date : 12th December, 2017

1 A massive victory

THE  HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date :12th December, 2017

Nepal's Left Alliance has the strength to deliver on governance

Given Nepal's mix of the first-past-the-post system and proportional representation, the final picture of its new Parliament may take some time to be clear. But it is already evident that the Left Alliance is on course to win more than 70% of the 165 parliamentary seats being decided by the FPTP system. In the 110 seats allocated based on proportional representation, the Communist Party of Nepal (Unified Marxist-Leninist) is leading, with its ally, the Communist Party of Nepal (Maoist-Centre), not far behind. This is a decisive victory for the Left Alliance, the first such win for the leftists since Nepal turned democratic in 1990. The UML had also emerged as the single largest party in the local elections held earlier this year; with the Maoists joining them in the run-up to the parliamentary polls, the resulting alliance has proved to be ideologically coherent. The UML expanded its support base beyond the hill-towns and the Terai into the far-west and the upper-hills, while the Maoists, who had floundered in elections since the formation of the Constituent Assembly in 2008, got second place and staved off decline. For the Nepali Congress, the third-place finish is a severe blow, limiting it to its weakest parliamentary presence. Others in the "democratic alliance" led by the NC, the plains-based Madhesi parties and the former royalist parties that tried using the Hindu card, have also received a setback.

...Contd.

1 A massive victory

...Contd.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1819

Date :12th December, 2017

It is quite clear that the Left Alliance's win draws from a yearning for a stable and lasting government after years of political instability. This is reflected in the fact that 13 leaders have held the post of Prime Minister since 1990. The Left Alliance has been seen as a natural coming together of like-minded forces which had both given up on radicalism and were willing to work within the parliamentary system. With such a big mandate, it is incumbent upon the alliance to finally focus on governance. Such transformative moments have been visible in the past too — during the initial sitting of the Constituent Assembly almost a decade ago when nearly the entire polity voted for Nepal to become a republic, or when the peace process between the Nepali state and the Maoists was completed, or after the earthquake in 2015 when political parties decided to quickly narrow down their differences on the Constitution in order to work together. But they all lapsed into more political wrangling. The Left Alliance now has both the opportunity and the strength to deliver on governance and development. As for the NC, the grand old party of Nepal has much to introspect on. It was blindsided by the formation of the Left Alliance and its own ragtag alliance was found to be wanting. It will now have to step up to play its role in opposition.

HINDU MONARCHY TO SECULAR, FEDERAL DEMOCRACY

NEPAL ... SALIENT FEATURES



- *“Tourism” is one of the flourishing industries in the country.*
- *Above 40% people live below poverty line.*
- *For trade, it is heavily dependent on India.*

- ✓ Himalayan country with ancient image.
- ✓ One of the world's poorest countries.
- ✓ Lot of diversity ... country is divided on ethnic lines, Nepali speaking vs indigenous languages, division based on gender.
- ✓ People speak more than 100 languages.
- ✓ Area ... 147,181 Sq.Km.
- ✓ Population ... around 29 million.
- ✓ GDP ... \$ 24 billion (nominal)
- ✓ Currency ... Nepalese Rupee

Indo-Nepal Friendship Treaty was signed in 1950.

1

“Hindu Monarchy” for around 240 years (till 2008)

2

Decade long civil war by Maoist rebels in 1990s and early 2000s resulted in death of more than 10,000 people and over 1,00,000 were displaced. However, peace deal was signed in 2006

3

Maoists emerged as the largest political grouping in the elections in 2008 & Monarchy was abolished in 2008

4

But the groups could not come to the consensus, hence failed to draft the Constitution till 2013

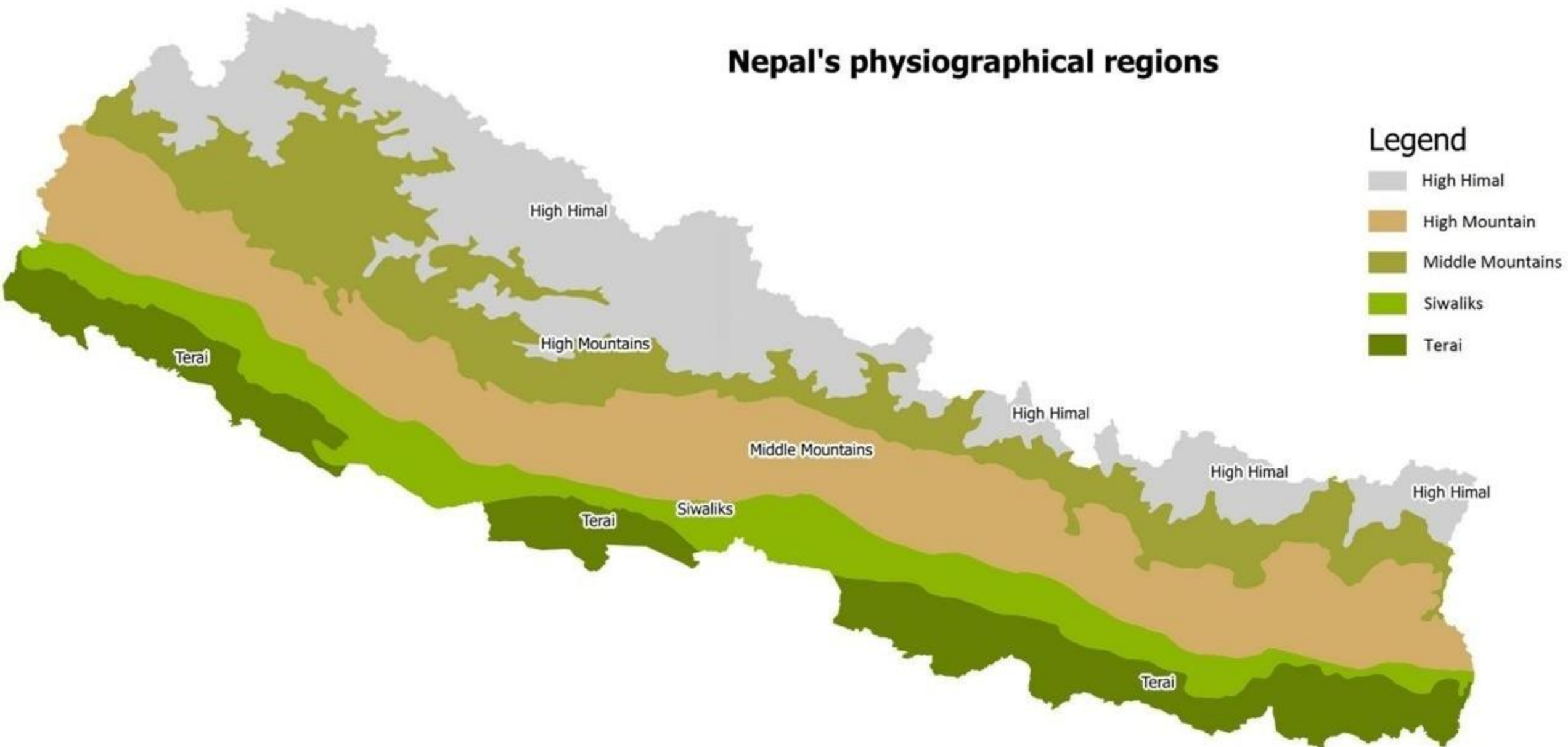
5

New Constituent Assembly was elected in 2013, once again dominated by the Maoists, Nepali Congress and others

6

Finally, the Constitution was voted by the Constituent Assembly. Entire Madhesi group boycotted and the Constitution was adopted on 20th Sept, 2015

Nepal's physiographical regions





EDITORIAL DISCUSSION

SPECIAL RELATIONSHIP INDIA - NEPAL

**LIVE**

AS PER "1950 INDIA-NEPAL TREATY OF PEACE AND FRIENDSHIP"

- 1 Everlasting peace and friendship between India & Nepal
- 2 Both the countries should inform each other any serious friction or misunderstanding with any neighbouring state
- 3 Visa free travel
- 4 Open borders
- 5 Nepal can freely import arms & ammunition required for its safety & security through the territory of India
- 6 "National treatment" to the nationals of other country in industrial and economic development
- 7 Same privileges to nationals of other country in the matter of residence, ownership of property and participation in trade and commerce

*It resulted in "**Roti-Beti Relation**" of Terai region people especially Madhesis with the people of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh in India*



NEWS REPORT

- Nepal has got a mix of the first-past-the-post system and proportional representation.
- Left Alliance of CPN (UML) is leading with its ally, CPN(MC) not far behind.
- It is the decisive victory for the Left Alliance.
- First such victory for leftists, since Nepal turned democratic in 1990.
- It is set back for democratic alliance led by Nepali Congress, Madhesi parties.



HOW TO INFER THIS?

- 1 This is a welcome sign after years of political instability.
- 2 13 leaders have held the post of Prime Minister since 1990.
- 3 It is natural coming together of like-minded forces.
- 4 Now, it is time to focus on Governance.
- 5 Now the alliance has to focus on Governance and Development.
- 6 The Nepali Congress, the grand old party of Nepal has much to do introspection.
- 7 It has to step up to play its role in the Opposition.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9